

IAS MAINS 2020

VALUE ADDITION

GS - I

GS - II

GS - III

GS - IV

12 QUESTIONS WITH MODEL ANSWERS

MODULE - 2

GS – I ... INDIAN SOCIETY

4

“In the Indian context, it is difficult to draw a dividing line between spiritual and religious discourses”. Elaborate the statement giving valid reasons. How far does this affect the secular credentials of India? (150 Words)

5

Failure to implement “safety related Government rules and regulations” proves fatal more for “have-nots” in comparison to “haves”. Discuss the issue with recent examples. (150 Words)

6

“Foundations of religion are essential to the life and practices of a society”. Elaborate the statement from the Indian context. (250 Words)

GS – II ... SOCIAL JUSTICE & GOVERNANCE

- 1 “Kuposhan Mukht Bharat (Malnutrition Free India) can only be attained through multi-dimensional approach, not by nutrition alone”. Give valid reasons to support the statement. Enlist the steps by the Government in this direction. (250 Words)
- 2 Discuss various similarities and divergences in the implementation of Aspirational Districts Programme and POSHAN Abhiyaan, as both the programmes are outcome-oriented. (250 Words)
- 3 Awareness and active participation of the downtrodden communities is the key for poverty alleviation. Discuss how far India is successful in this perspective. (150 Words)

GS – III ... ENVIRONMENT & DISASTER MANAGEMENT

- 1 Man-animal conflicts are quite often debated in the context of wildlife protection. Narrate various innovative practices adopted in India, in recent times, to prevent man-animal conflicts. (150 Words)
- 2 Community participation is the key to wildlife preservation. Analyze the positive impact of various community-led efforts in preserving wildlife, with specific examples. (150 Words)
- 3 Coastal erosion and sinking of islands affect the vulnerable communities like fishermen badly. Give specific recent examples. Discuss various adaptation measures required to minimize the risk. (250 Words)

GS – IV ... ETHICS, INTEGRITY &
APTITUDE

- 4 Differentiate between responsibility and accountability. Why is the accountability of political executive necessary for a mature democracy? Explain with examples. (250 Words)
- 5 What is Probity in governance? Discuss the ways to ensure Probity in governance? (250 Words)
- 6 Brief about the 7 sins mentioned by Mahatma Gandhi. Analyse their applicability in today's society? (250 Words)

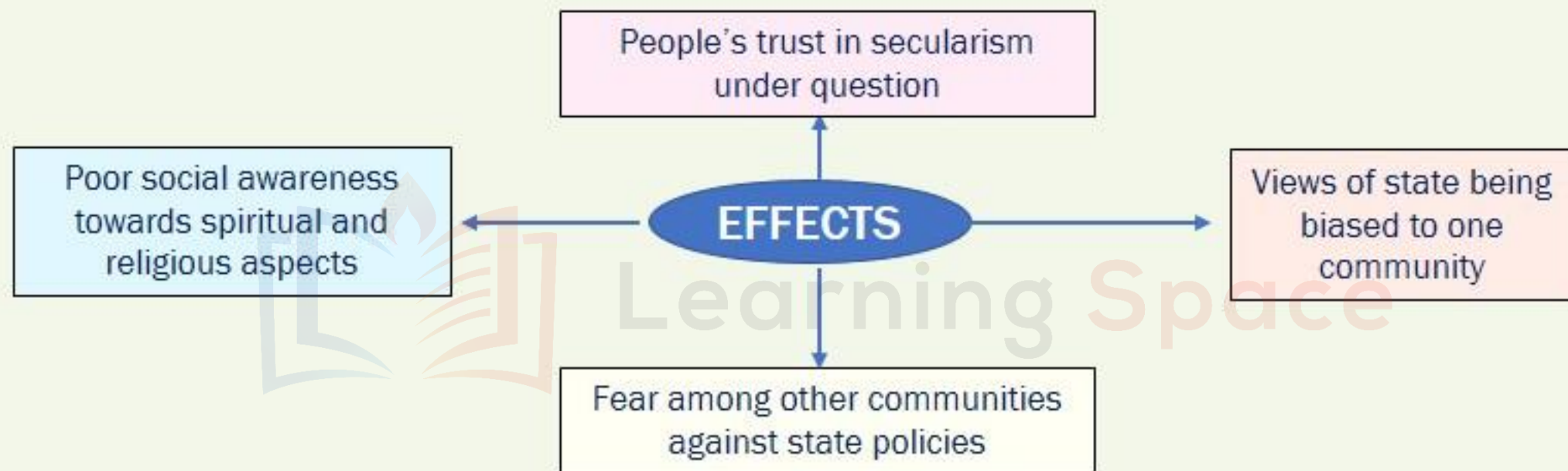
“In the Indian context, it is difficult to draw a dividing line between spiritual and religious discourses”. Elaborate the statement giving valid reasons. How far does this affect the secular credentials of India? (150 Words)

Indian Secularism allows for principled state intervention. But the state should neither promote nor demote any religion. The intermingling of spiritual and religious elements has put the secular credentials of state under question.

RECENT INCIDENTS OF SPIRITUAL ELEMENTS ATTAINING RELIGIOUS TINGE

1. Chanting spiritual prayers in schools opposed in the name of religious sentiments
2. Mandating national anthem in schools as against their religion
3. Adopting yoga for physical well-being tinted as religious imposition
4. Increase in spiritual organisations seen as a threat to other religious communities
5. Spiritual gurus wrongly perceived as religious leaders

EFFECT ON INDIAN SECULARISM



WAY AHEAD

State should take into account the fears of other communities by conducting inclusive dialogues. Basic ethics of all religions should be part of school education to create aware and informed citizens.

Failure to implement “safety related Government rules and regulations” proves fatal more for “have-nots” in comparison to “haves”. Discuss the issue with recent examples. (150 Words)

The have nots are at the first line of destruction as they are often neglected in policy making and implementation of safety rules. Being voiceless, they experience the lack of access to Justice or resources to protect them.

RECENT INCIDENTS

1. Negligence of local governance to fill unused borewells - children of downtrodden sections often became victims (Tamil Nadu).
2. Poor regulation of building bylaws - Fall of apartments in Mumbai led to death of construction workers.
3. Poor regulation of liquor sale disrupts the lives of downtrodden sections - Bihar hooch tragedy.
4. Lack of safety assessment practices - Stampede at Mumbai's Elphinstone Road station.
5. Inferior quality assessment in construction material - Majerhat Bridge collapse in Kolkata led to death of street dwellers.
6. Absence of regular cleanliness drives in vacant lands - Vacant lands becoming breeding grounds for waste disposal and diseases affecting slum dwellers.

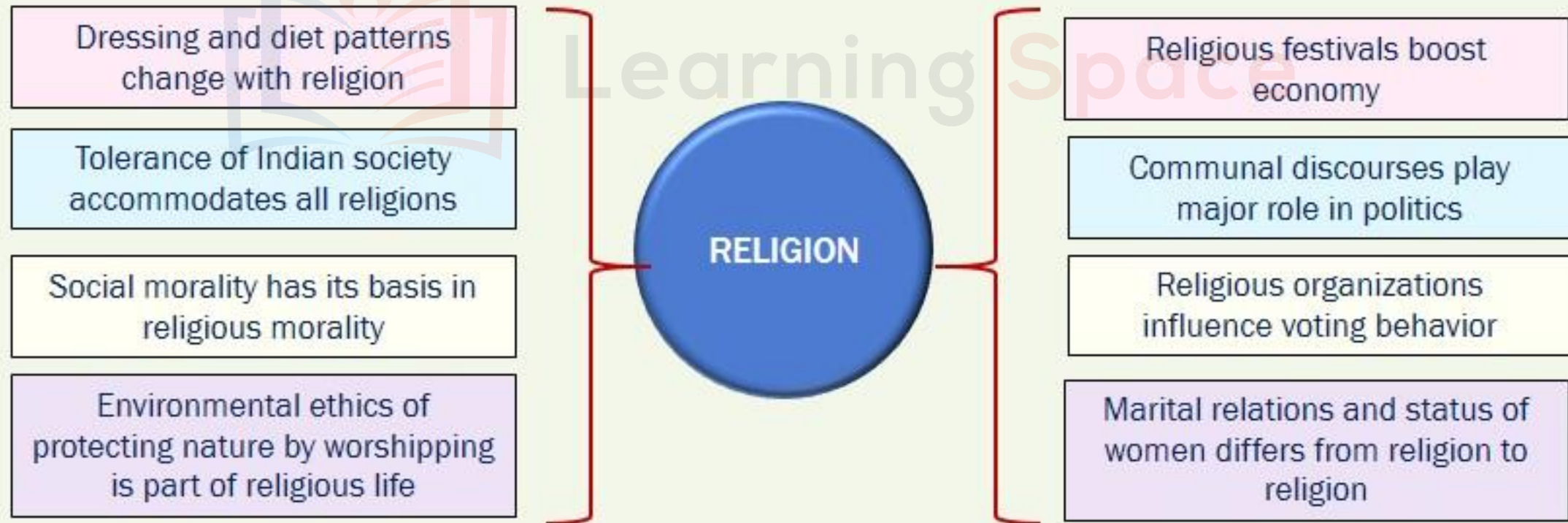
WAY AHEAD

Public policy making should always consider the safety and interests of downtrodden sections of the society. Strong bureaucratic will and awareness among the sections are necessary for successful implementation.

**“Foundations of religion are essential to the life and practices of a society”.
Elaborate the statement from the Indian context. (250 Words)**

Indian Society has foundation strongly ingrained in religion than any other country. The cultural and traditional practices enter the domain of state, business, private and public lives.

RELIGION AND SOCIAL LIFE IN INDIA



ISSUES OF RELIGIOUS PLURALITY

- Multiple religions may create dividing lines in society
- Lack of awareness of other religions leads to misunderstanding
- Politicizing religious discourse leading to communal clashes
- Religious clashes because of conversions

WAY AHEAD

Multiculturalism is a core element of Indian cultural ethos. It involves all communities existing in harmony by respecting each other's practices. Awareness through education, campaigns regarding oneness of all religions can advance multiculturalism in Indian society.

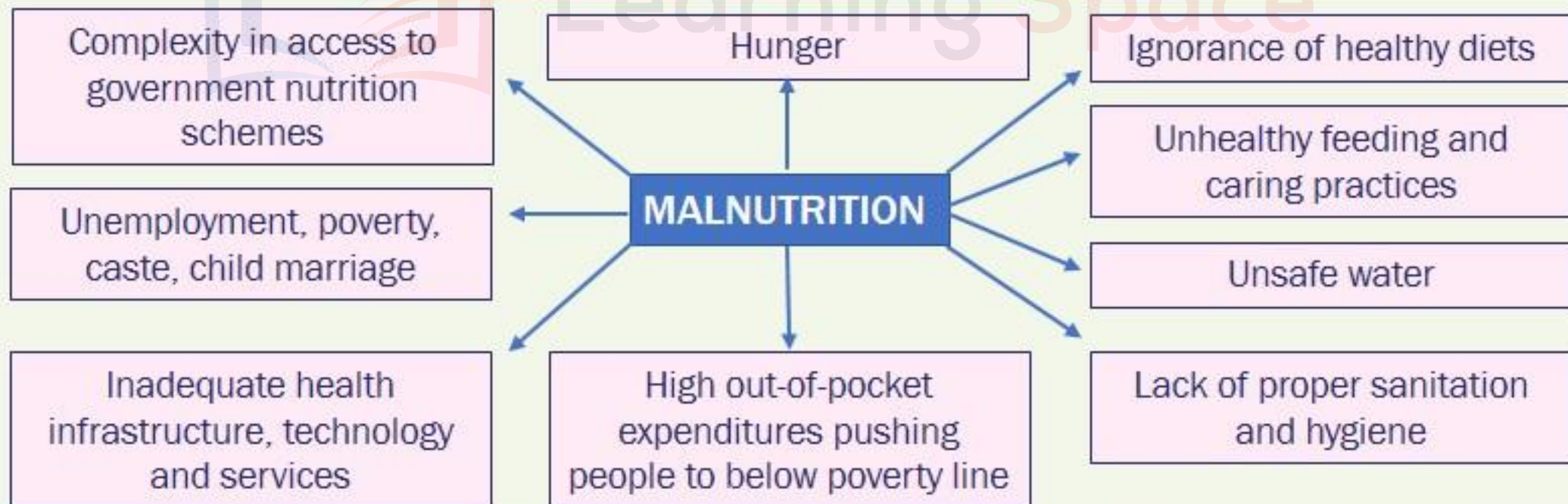
Learning Space



“Kuposhan Mukht Bharat (Malnutrition Free India) can only be attained through multi-dimensional approach, not by nutrition alone”. Give valid reasons to support the statement. Enlist the steps by the Government in this direction. (250 Words)

Indian government proposed to achieve “Kuposhan Mukht Bharat” – free from malnutrition – across the life cycle by 2022. But, Global Hunger Index, 2019 placed India at 102 out of 117 countries. This shows the need for multi-sectoral initiative, convergence approach, education and community awareness to realise malnutrition free India.

MULTIPLE FACTORS CAUSING MALNUTRITION



MULTI-DIMENSIONAL APPROACH – NEED OF THE HOUR

GOVERNANCE

- Nutritious food through schemes like Mid-day-meal etc.
- Not mandating Aadhaar seeding to receive ration
- Innovative means to make the scheme public friendly.
Eg: Use of DBT, Village secretariats with digital technologies

SOCIAL

- Community participation for clean village

INFRASTRUCTURE

- Better sanitation
- Good municipal solid waste management practices
- Disposal of waste from habitat

BEHAVIOURAL

- Nudge towards WASH principles
- Change in lifestyles towards healthy dietary pattern

STEPS TAKEN BY THE GOVERNMENT

1. POSHAN Abhiyaan
2. Aspirational districts programmes
3. Mid-day-meal scheme
4. Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) scheme
5. Mother Absolute Affection (MAA) programme
6. Zero hunger programme
7. Rashtriya Poshan Maah (National Nutrition Month)
8. Swachh Bharat Mission, WASH initiative

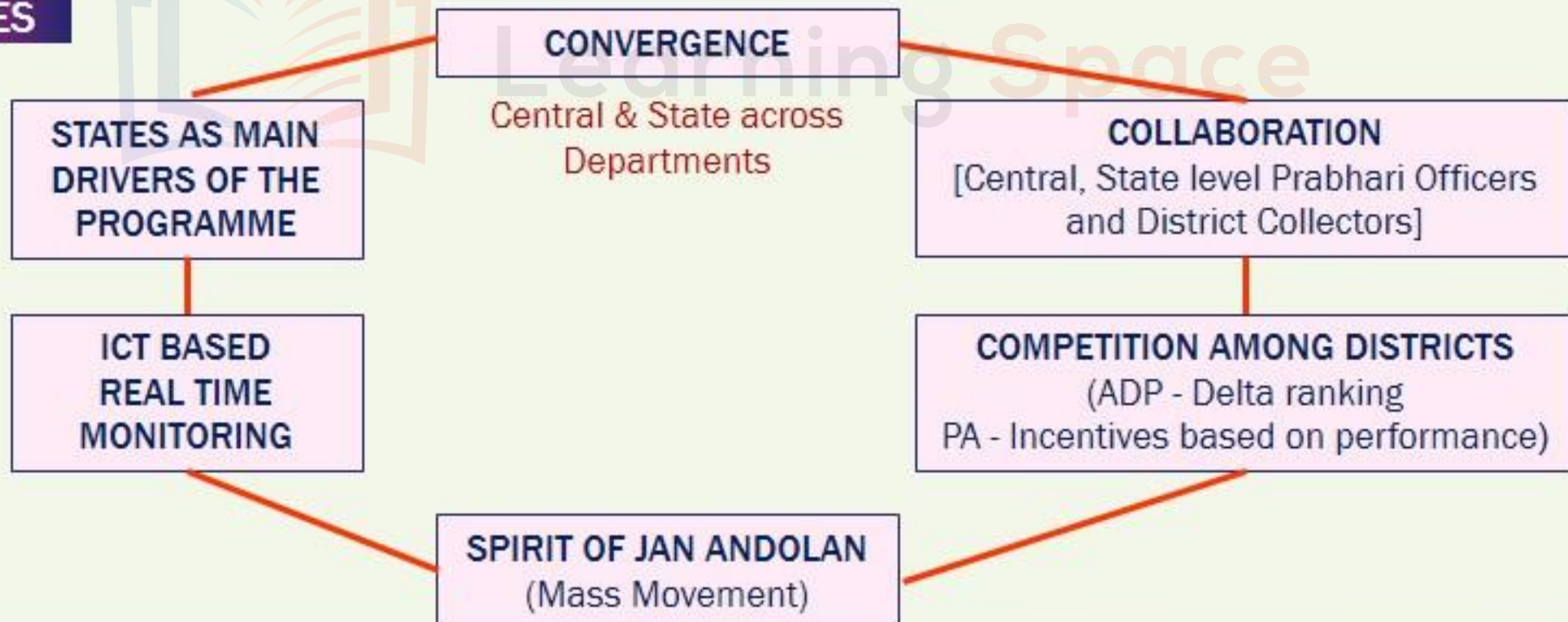
WAY AHEAD

Success of government initiatives depends on community participation. Cutting edge bureaucracy should reach grassroots to enable transparency, accountability and participatory governance to achieve “Kuposhan Mukta Bharat”.



Discuss various similarities and divergences in the implementation of Aspirational Districts Programme and POSHAN Abhiyaan, as both the programmes are outcome-oriented. (250 Words)

While POSHAN ABHIYAN (PA) deals with comprehensive nutritional approach towards healthy India, Aspirational Districts Programme (ADP) aims at inclusive development by reducing regional disparities in living standards and poverty. These schemes marked a shift from output based to outcome oriented.

SIMILARITIES

IAS MAINS 2020 - VALUE ADDITION

DIVERGENCES	ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICT PROGRAMME	POSHAN ABHIYAN
Goal	Remove heterogeneities in living standards, poverty across states and districts, primarily to realize the goal of New India	Improve nutritional status of children from 0-6 years, adolescent girls, pregnant women
Focus Area	- Health and nutrition - Education - Agriculture and water resources - Financial inclusion - Skill development	- Reduce stunting, under-nutrition and low-birth weight by 2% per annum - Reduce anemia among young children, women and adolescent girls by 3% per annum - Reduce stunting from 38.4% (NFHS4) to 25% by 2022 (Mission 25 by 2022)
Regions	117 districts in 28 states - Includes 35 left wing extremists districts	All states and districts in a phased manner
Schemes	District Specific Action Plan - Based on low hanging fruits	Relatively less district specific
Deadlines	No time based targets but continuous progress is monitored	Time based targets to be achieved by 2022
Impact	Improves people's ability to participate in inclusive economy	- Malnutrition free India - Reduce health expenditure of people

WAY AHEAD

With some divergences, both the schemes ensure healthy and inclusive India. The key to success of these programs is people's participation. Government should bring in innovative ways (using multimedia, social media, celebrity campaigning) to make these programmes a Jan Andolan in a real sense.

Awareness and active participation of the downtrodden communities is the key for poverty alleviation. Discuss how far India is successful in this perspective. (150 Words)

Community participation is the key to success of any government programme. Despite various poverty alleviation measures, 22% of Indians are still poor (Tendulkar committee).

POVERTY ALLEVIATION APPROACHES ... THEIR IMPACT

PHASE 1: TRICKLE DOWN APPROACH

- Benefits of economic development didn't reach downtrodden communities

PHASE 2: FOOD FOR WORK

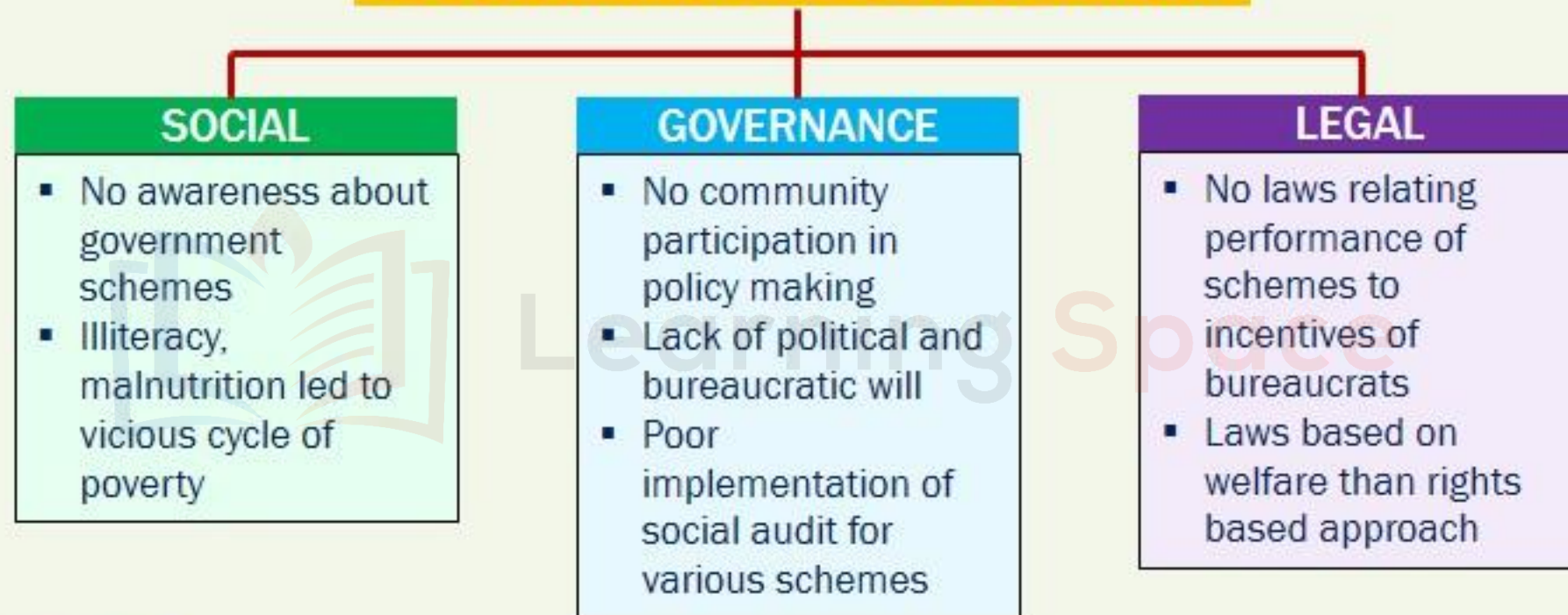
- Some success with people's participation
- Schemes like MGNREGA enabled better incomes

PHASE 3: WELFARE APPROACH

- Schemes like ICDS, Ayushman Bharat
- Little success due to lack of awareness among downtrodden sections



REASONS FOR POOR COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION



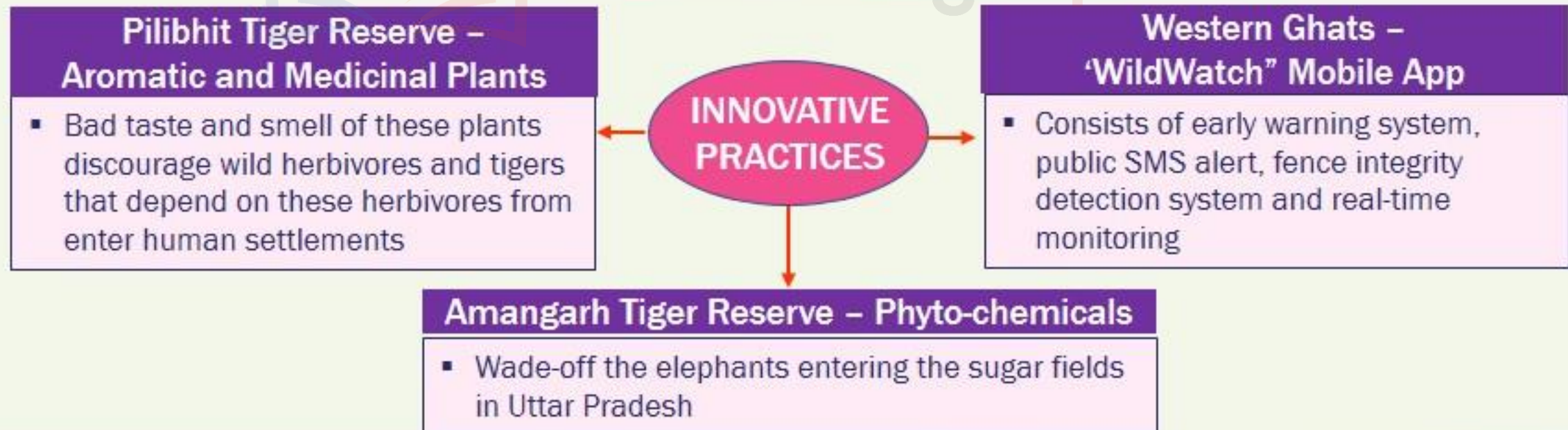
WAY AHEAD

State should collaborate with NGOs, SHGs in creating awareness among downtrodden section. Involvement of backward sections in policy making and social audit are must to alleviate poverty.

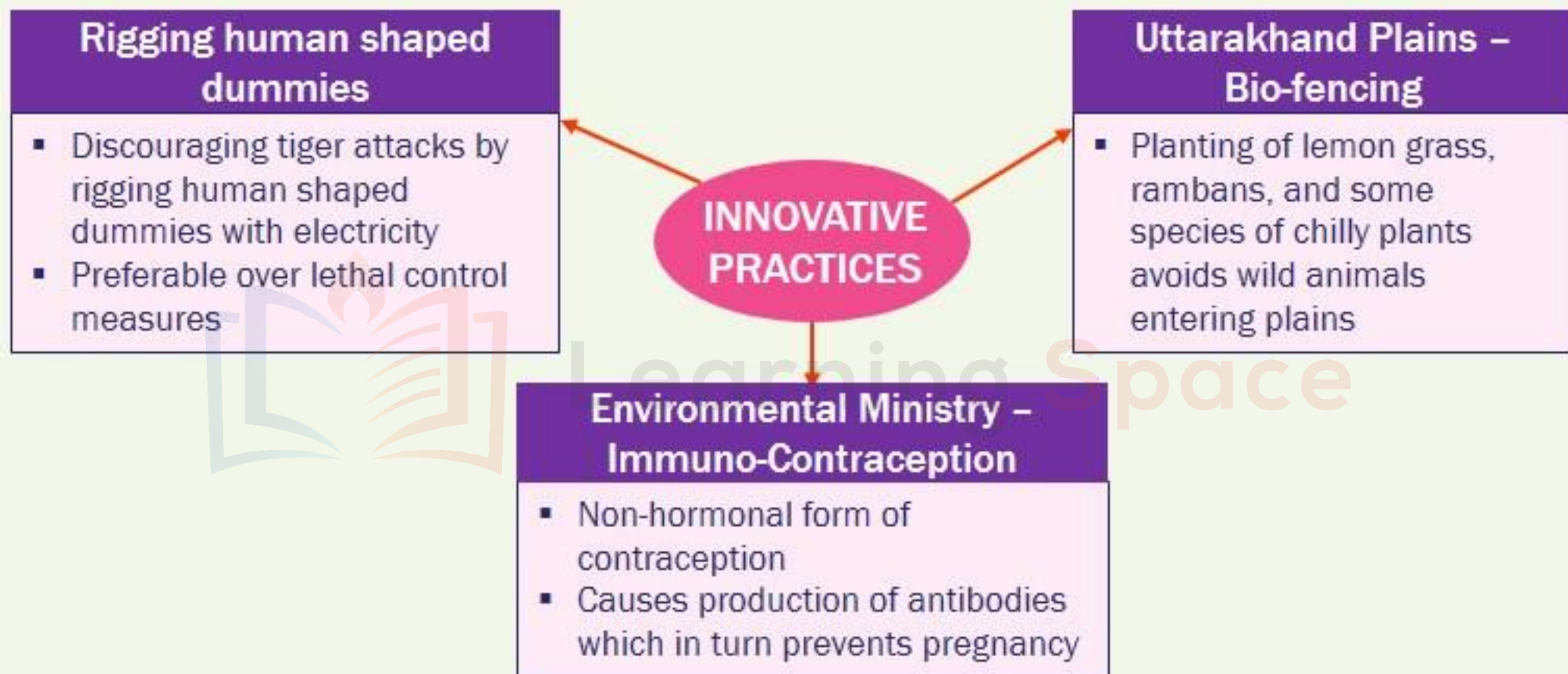
Man-animal conflicts are quite often debated in the context of wildlife protection. Narrate various innovative practices adopted in India, in recent times, to prevent man-animal conflicts. (150 Words)

Man-animal conflict leads to a no-win situation: according to the government, 2400 people died in elephant attacks and 230 in tiger attacks in the last five years. Poaching of tigers, elephants and other wildlife in various protected areas and urban centres has questioned the government's commitment to wild-life protection. In this context, new practices to avoid man-animal conflicts are emerging day-by-day.

VARIOUS INNOVATIVE PRACTICES ADOPTED IN INDIA



VARIOUS INNOVATIVE PRACTICES ADOPTED IN INDIA



These innovative practices act as short-term solutions to man-animal conflict. Long-term solution lies in making state policies environment inclusive and developing a culture of tolerance among humans.

2 / E&DM
GS – III

Community participation is the key to wildlife preservation. Analyze the positive impact of various community-led efforts in preserving wildlife, with specific examples. (150 Words)

In recent times, community participation in protecting wildlife increased in India. The Indian Biodiversity Awards, 2018 is a step towards recognizing the importance of community participation in conserving wildlife. It creates win-win situation on the conservation front along with securing the rights of forest dwellers.

POSITIVE IMPACTS OF VARIOUS COMMUNITY-LED EFFORTS IN PRESERVING WILDLIFE

1. Nyishi community participation resulted in the Pakke Tiger Reserve doing better than the Namdapha Tiger Reserve in Arunachal Pradesh.
2. Communities of Manipur are socially economically, culturally and ecologically connected with the Loktak Lake and Keibul Lamjao National Park (Sangai Deer).
3. Chilika transformed from being hunting and poaching ground to award winning eco-tourism hub.
4. Bishnoi community in Rajasthan is known for its nature worship and wildlife conservation (Black buck, Khejri trees).
5. Singchung Bagan village community in Arunachal Pradesh conserved Bugun Liocichla bird.
6. Phom tribe by ceasing hunting transformed community-owned forest into a refuge for wildlife in Longleng, Nagaland.

WAY AHEAD

Sacred groves, which are known for wildlife conservation, already existed in India. Rather than isolating the communities, engaging people in such a way that their cultural values are infused with scientific management is the key to wildlife conservation.



3 / E&DM GS – III

Coastal erosion and sinking of islands affect the vulnerable communities like fishermen badly. Give specific recent examples. Discuss various adaptation measures required to minimize the risk. (250 Words)

India has lost 33% coastline due to erosion between 1990 and 2006 (National Centre for Coastal Research report, 2018).

Islands like Sundarbans are rapidly sinking because of melting snow and rising sea level driven by Global Warming.

EXAMPLES IN RECENT TIMES

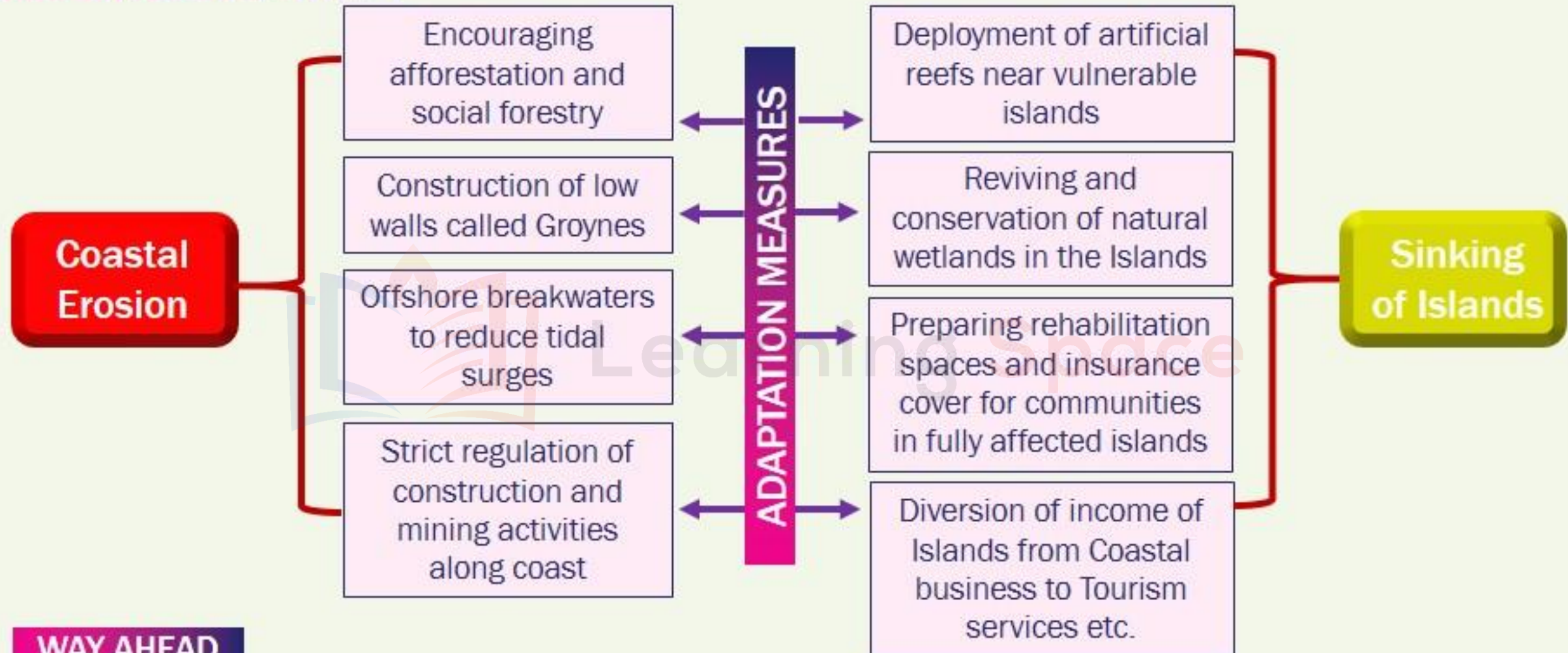
COASTAL EROSION IN INDIA	SINKING OF ISLANDS
- West Bengal (63%) and Puducherry (57%) are most vulnerable to erosion. - Mining and construction activities across Andhra coastal belt resulted in coastal erosion.	- Islands across Sundarbans like Sagar, Ghoramara experiencing the rising sea level. - Satabhaya village on the Odisha coast almost swallowed by the Bay of Bengal. - Munroe Thuruthu island's (Kerala) decline began with the construction of the Thenmala dam.

ADVERSE EFFECTS ON VULNERABLE COMMUNITIES

- Livelihood of fisherman gets affected due to reduced fish catch.
- Soil-salinization due to seawater ingress - dearth of fodder for livestock.
- Destruction of existing habitats of shore flora and fauna.
- Disruption of lifestyle of coastal communities.
- Coastal communities becoming climate refugees.



ADAPTATION MEASURES

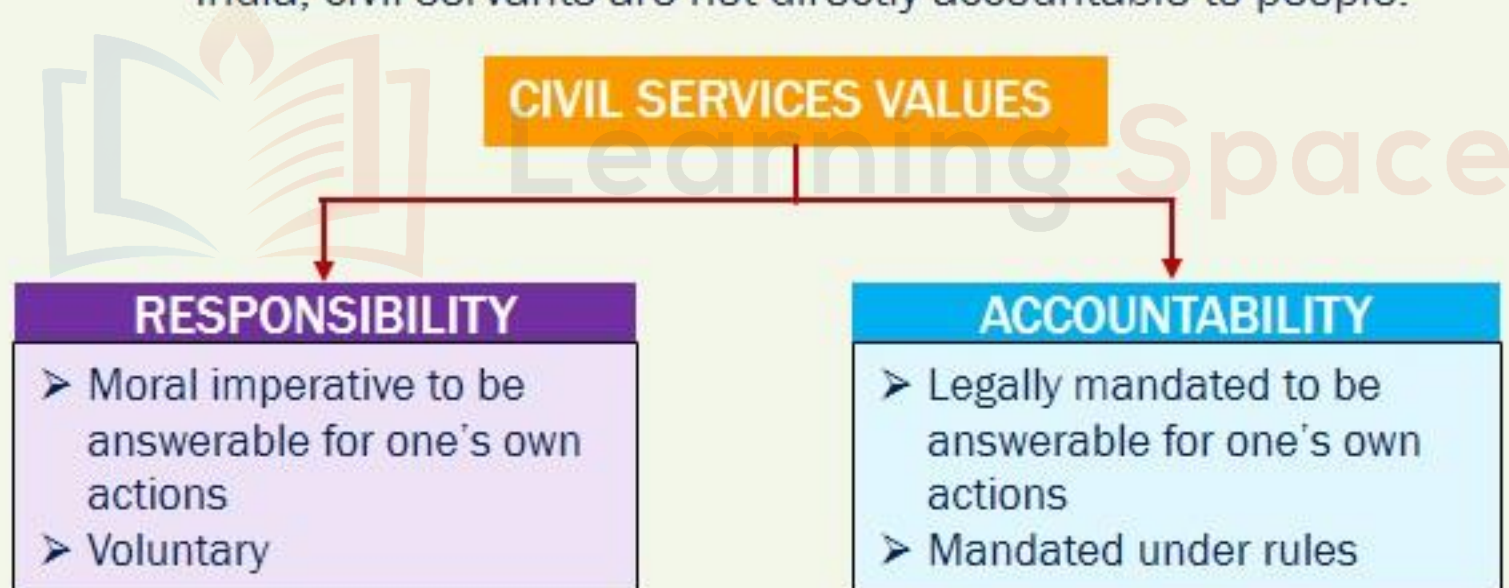


WAY AHEAD

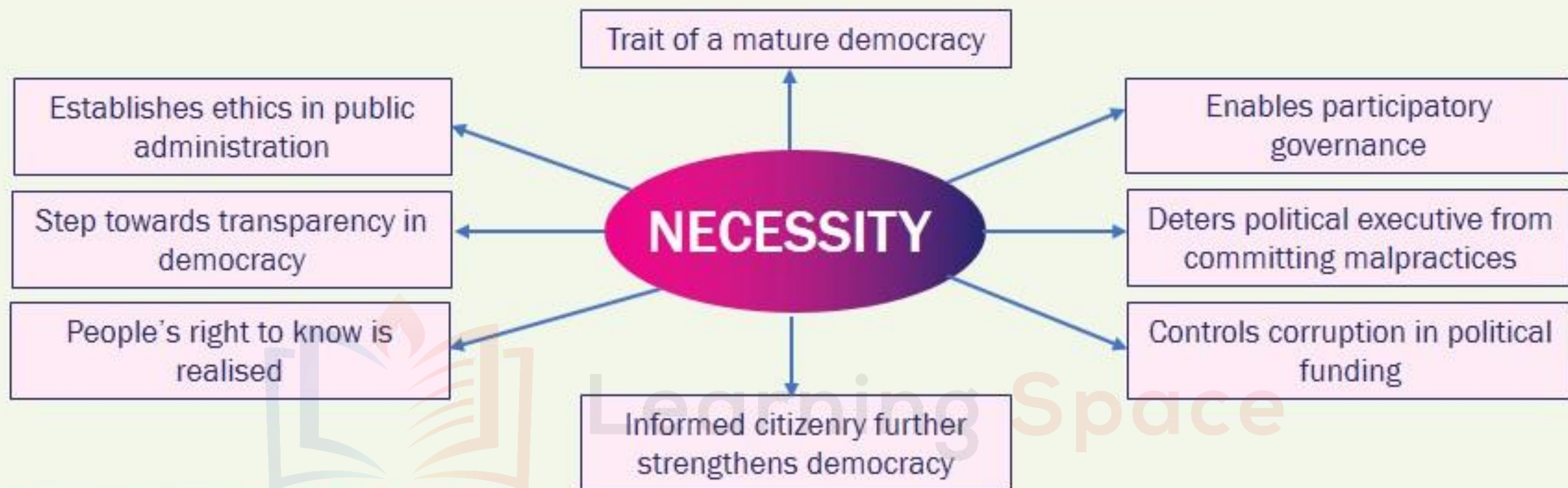
Global co-operation to counter global-warming and climate change is the only viable long-term solution. Traditional knowledge of the local people should be included in the policies regarding adaptative measures.

Differentiate between responsibility and accountability. Why is the accountability of political executive necessary for a mature democracy? Explain with examples.
(250 Words)

Responsibility and accountability are both part of civil services values. But in a parliamentary democracy like India, civil servants are not directly accountable to people.



Eg: District collectors are morally responsible to people for everything happening in the district. But they are legally accountable only to their superiors in hierarchy and political masters.



STEPS TAKEN BY GOVERNMENT

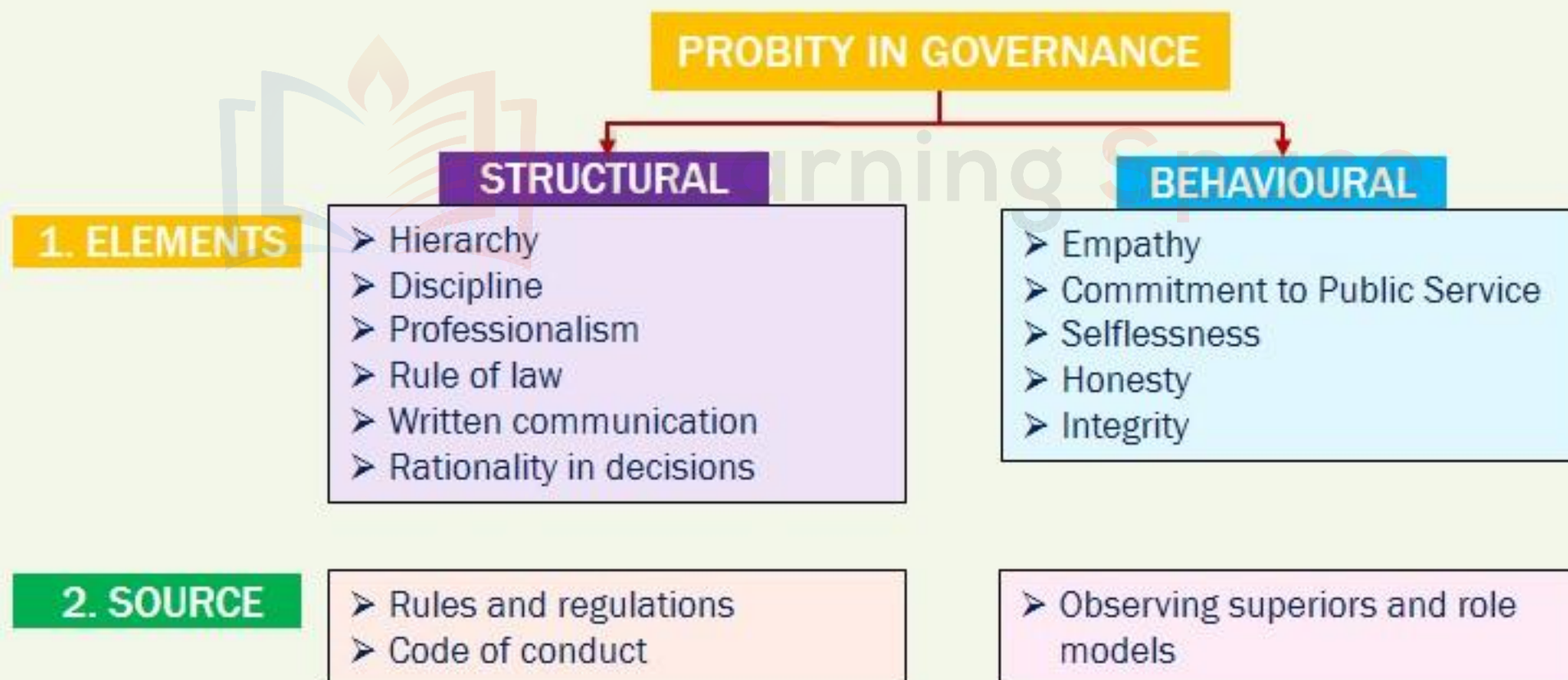
- Enacting Right to Information act
- Mandating to submit assets of the executive annually
- Enabling social audit through acts like MGNREGA
- Introduction of citizen's charter

WAY AHEAD

Implementation of social audit, citizens charter should happen in real sense. Laws are to be made towards oath of transparency rather than secrecy once the political executive are appointed.

What is Probity in governance? Discuss the ways to ensure Probity in governance?
(250 Words)

Probity in governance is a multidimensional term involving structural and behavioural aspects of administration.



REASONS FOR ABSENCE OF PROBITY

- Rise of materialism and selfish motives
 - Honesty is rarely rewarded and corruption is rarely punished.
 - Civil servants hail from the same society.
 - Obsession to get promotions
 - Unlimited access to resources of society makes it impossible to resist temptation.
- “Power Corrupts. Absolute Power Corrupts absolutely” – Lord Acton

WAYS TO ENSURE PROBITY

- Implementing code of ethics
- Ensure civil servants abide to code of conduct
- Transforming bureaucratic attitudes to democratic values
- Linking performance incentives of civil servants to strict implementation of citizen's charter and social audit
- Recruiting individuals with strong value system and morality
- Strengthening people with RTI

WAY AHEAD

Strong political and bureaucratic will coupled with informed citizenry is the gateway for mature democracy

Brief about the 7 sins mentioned by Mahatma Gandhi. Analyse their applicability in today's society? (250 Words)

Gandhian philosophy of good governance involves not committing the 7 sins mentioned by him. They are:

1. POLITICS WITHOUT PRINCIPLES

Today's Reality

Objective of

Politics

Grab power for long time

Ethics

Work for society

Not going together

NEED

Power not as an end in itself but means to social service is must to move towards better society.

2. WEALTH WITHOUT WORK

Today's Reality

Subsidies, free power and wavier of loans led to wastage of these resources. Eg: 80% of water in India is used for irrigation.

NEED

All welfare schemes are to be made conditional on maintaining clean atmosphere, constructing toilets, child education etc.



3. KNOWLEDGE WITHOUT CHARACTER

Today's Reality

New variety of crimes, cyber attacks due to free access to knowledge but not moral values

NEED

State should provide technological access conditional on the ability of its citizens to put technology to good use.

4. COMMERCE WITHOUT MORALITY

Today's Reality

Capitalism thriving on profit maximization through any means

NEED

Corporate ethics like social responsibility are to be promoted.

5. Science without Humanity

Today's Reality

Experiments on humans, nuclear weapons are increasing.

NEED

Imbibing human values has to be part of science in education at all levels.

6. PLEASURE WITHOUT CONSCIENCE

Today's Reality

Fulfilling desires without considering moral and ethical aspects
Eg: Sexual violence against women, drug menace

NEED

Spiritual awareness should be inculcated during education. This makes individuals self aware.

7. WORSHIP WITHOUT SACRIFICE

Today's Reality

Blind worship of charismatic people but inconsiderate to fellow humans

NEED

Serving fellow humans is not only a sacrifice but direct devotion to god.

CONCLUSION:

All the 7sins of Gandhi are still applicable as discussed. A society that strictly abides to not committing these sins will definitely be the most progressive.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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